

TOURNAMENT REVENUE SYSTEM

Sponsor Studio & Tournament Campaign Platform

A protected, modular plan for sponsor-themed tournaments, in-game placements, fundraising messages, approvals, measurement, and safe operations.

COUNT DOWN 31 / PRODUCT + UX + TECHNICAL PLAN / 25 AUG 2026

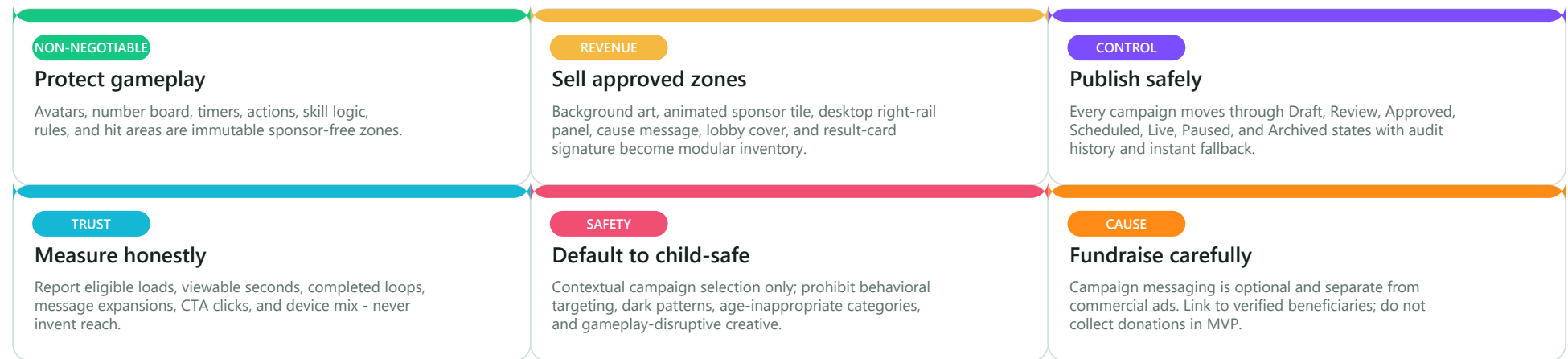
PLANNING ONLY

No code, schema, or production configuration is changed by this document.

01 / EXECUTIVE DECISION

Build a Tournament Campaign Layer - not a global reskin

The existing Game Studio remains the house configuration. A new Sponsor Studio attaches a versioned campaign package to one tournament at a time.



Recommended product name: Tournament Sponsor Studio. Recommended runtime object: TournamentCampaign. Recommended default: house theme with every placement disabled until an approved campaign is scheduled.

DOCUMENT MAP

What this plan covers

	Product strategy	Current state, principles, inventory, sponsor packages
	Player experience	Desktop/mobile zones, animation, cause message, disclosures
	Admin experience	Information architecture, builder, workflow, preview, approvals
	Technical design	Data model, APIs, assets, runtime resolution, analytics
	Protection	Security, accessibility, child safety, fundraising, operations
	Delivery	Hypothetical campaign, phases, tests, risks, decision checklist

Implementation begins only after the owner approves this plan and resolves the decisions on page 33.

A / PRODUCT STRATEGY

Current codebase: strong foundations, one dangerous coupling

The project already has most of the account and tournament plumbing. The missing piece is a tournament-scoped campaign object.

Existing capability	Evidence in code	Planning implication
Tournament CRUD + approvals	admin/tournament + /admin/promo-tournaments	Extend instead of replace
Sponsor accounts + portal	Sponsor model, sponsor JWT, claim codes	Keep sponsor identity separate from players
Tournament-to-sponsor link	SponsorTournament.sponsorId	Campaign inherits sponsor ownership
Global Game Studio	GameConfig + AdminGameStudio	Do not reuse global writes for campaigns
Background upload	/admin/config/assets/background	Generalize into safe campaign assets
Tournament brand registry	brands.ts: WM + VA	Migrate hardcoded skins into data
Tournament room awareness	roomId != practice	Resolve campaign by tournament ID
Animated cow mascot	BarnabyMascot + TransparentVideo	Add sponsor logo renderer as a separate zone

Critical issue to avoid: today the global GameConfig affects all tournament rooms. Sponsor creative must never be saved into that singleton, or one campaign could overwrite practice mode and unrelated tournaments.

A / PRODUCT STRATEGY

Seven design laws

1. Game first

Advertising must never obscure, resize, reorder, delay, or mimic gameplay controls.

2. Tournament scoped

A campaign belongs to a tournament; no global side effects.

3. Explicitly sponsored

Every commercial placement carries a nearby plain-language disclosure.

4. Reversible

One admin action pauses the campaign and restores the house fallback.

5. Versioned

Live creative is immutable. Edits create a draft version and require review.

6. Contextual only

Select campaigns by tournament, region, device, and schedule - not behavioral profiles.

7. Accessible by default

Reduced motion, pause/hide controls, contrast masks, keyboard access, no flashing.

8. Honest metrics

Count only eligible delivery and viewability; preserve raw aggregate events for audit.

9. Cause separation

Fundraising messages have beneficiary and disclosure fields independent from ad copy.

A / PRODUCT STRATEGY

Sponsor inventory: six sellable placements

Start with fixed, safe placements. Avoid arbitrary drag-anywhere elements in production.

Zone	Surface	Creative	Default cap	Primary metric
S1 Animated logo tile	Desktop bottom-left; mobile compact tile	Transparent PNG/WebP/SVG converted to safe raster	120x120 desktop / 52x52 mobile	Viewable seconds
S2 Arena background	Tournament game backdrop	JPG/WebP, protected contrast mask	1920x1080 <= 2 MB	Eligible loads
S3 Desktop feature panel	Unused bottom-right field	Static image + short copy + optional CTA	320x180; one panel	Viewability + click
S4 Cause message	Below board / collapsed mobile card	Headline, 140-char body, beneficiary, CTA	Once per match; dismissible	Expand + CTA
S5 Tournament lobby hero	Events list + detail page	Cover art, logo, sponsor line	16:9 cover	Detail visits
S6 Result signature	Victory/defeat result footer	Small sponsor logo + 'Presented by'	No animation	Result views

Never sell: avatar skins, number cards, game board frame, timer, skills, join/confirm buttons, opponent cards, stats HUD, navigation, elimination logic, or sound cues that imply game state.

A / PRODUCT STRATEGY

Commercial packages without clutter

Package	Included	Use case	Guardrail
Presented by	Lobby hero + result signature	Small local sponsor	No in-match animation
Arena partner	Adds background + animated tile	Brand awareness	One looping element only
Tournament takeover	Adds feature panel + cause message	Flagship campaign	Desktop rich; mobile compact
Cause campaign	Cause message + verified external CTA	Fundraising/awareness	No donation handling in MVP

Pricing should be contract-based at launch. Do not build an automated ad auction, per-user targeting, or self-serve billing until delivery data and brand-safety operations are proven.

B / PLAYER EXPERIENCE

Desktop tournament arena: protected core, monetized edges

The sponsor can own the atmosphere and unused space without touching the game's identity or controls.

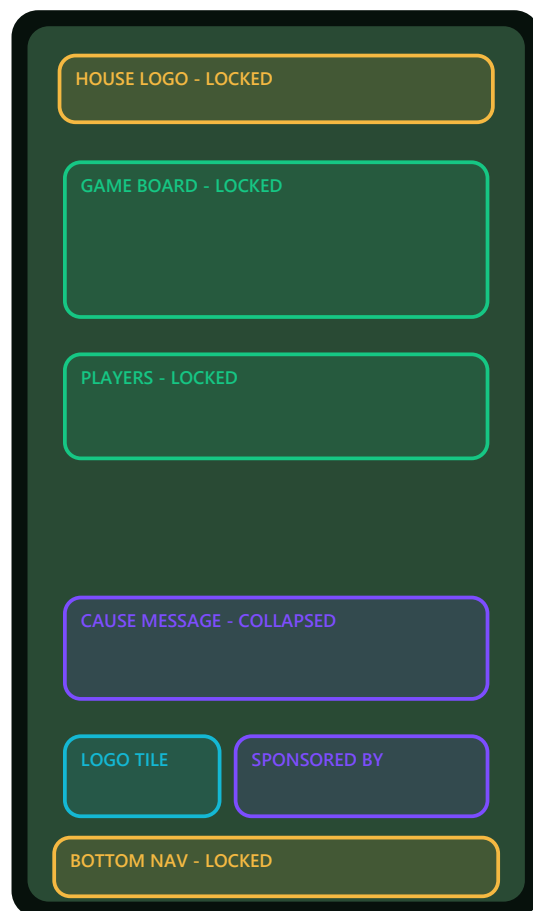


Placement order: house identity first, disclosure second, gameplay third, sponsor enhancements around the perimeter. The right-rail panel collapses entirely when disabled or when its creative fails validation.

B / PLAYER EXPERIENCE

Mobile mapping: less inventory, stricter limits

Mobile keeps the existing game-first shell. No large right-rail ad exists; sponsor content becomes compact, dismissible, and lower-priority.



Mobile rules

- Logo tile is small and outside the card selection path.
- Cause message defaults collapsed; opens as a bottom sheet between rounds.
- Feature panel is omitted, never squeezed beside player cards.
- Background may change, but a locked contrast overlay protects readability.
- Reduced-motion preference converts loops to a static logo.
- No sponsor CTA appears while a 7-second turn timer is active.

Recommendation

Sponsor value on mobile should come from repeated, safe recognition across lobby, background, logo tile, and result signature - not from a single intrusive unit.

B / PLAYER EXPERIENCE

Animated logo system: presets, not arbitrary CSS

The admin chooses from reviewed motion presets. The sponsor uploads art; the platform owns animation behavior.

Float Slow 6-second vertical drift with soft shadow. Default and safest preset.	Turntable Gentle 8-second Y-axis rotation with perspective; pauses on hover/focus.	Orbit Small circular path, maximum 8 px radius, 10-second loop.
Pulse Scale 1.00 to 1.05 over 5 seconds. No flashing or opacity strobe.	Card flip One 900 ms flip every 8 seconds, not continuous spinning.	Static Mandatory fallback for reduced motion, low power, unsupported assets, or admin choice.

Admin controls: preset, speed tier (slow/standard), scale within approved bounds, anchor zone, start delay, loop count or continuous, pause button, mobile enable, reduced-motion fallback, and preview. No free-form CSS, JavaScript, or HTML is accepted.

B / PLAYER EXPERIENCE

Cause and fundraising message: useful, optional, verifiable

Field	Purpose	Rule
Enabled	Admin kill switch	Off by default
Mode	Awareness / fundraiser / sponsor purpose	Plain-language label
Headline	Why the tournament exists	Max 60 characters
Message	Short explanation	Max 140 characters in-game
Beneficiary	Named receiving organization	Required for fundraising
Verification	Internal evidence and review date	Admin-only record
CTA	Learn more / donate externally	HTTPS allowlist; no mid-turn CTA
Disclosure	Who receives funds, fees, timing, data sharing	Shown before external action
Schedule	When message appears	Lobby, between rounds, results

MVP recommendation: Count Down 31 never receives or routes donations. The CTA opens a verified beneficiary or sponsor landing page in a clearly labeled external browser destination. Native giving can be considered only after legal, payments, receipts, refund, fee, and beneficiary controls exist.

B / PLAYER EXPERIENCE

Disclosure and interaction rules

Use plain labels

Use 'Advertisement', 'Sponsored by', or 'Paid sponsor message'. Do not rely on a logo alone.

Place disclosure nearby

Attach the label to each creative focal point; do not hide it in settings or terms.

Do not mimic controls

Sponsor tiles cannot look like number cards, skill buttons, rewards, balance, or system alerts.

No turn interruption

No modal, audio ad, CTA, or expanded message while the player must act.

Pause or hide motion

Any auto-loop over five seconds has a visible pause/hide mechanism unless reduced to static.

External link warning

CTA shows destination domain and opens only after deliberate user activation.

Recommended in-game label pattern: Sponsored by [Brand]. Recommended cause pattern: Cause partner: [Organization]. If commercial and cause content share a unit, show both relationships separately.

C / ADMIN EXPERIENCE

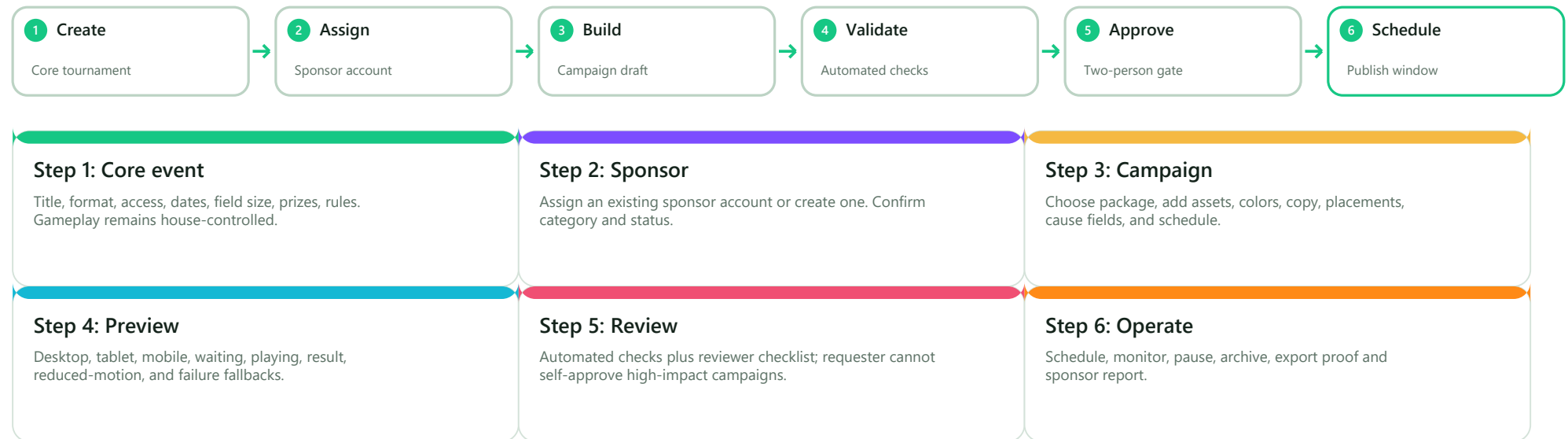
Admin information architecture



Admin area	Primary jobs	Permission
Tournament Manager	Create event, sponsor assignment, dates, access, prizes, status	Tournament editor
Sponsor Studio	Theme, placements, assets, cause message, preview, version notes	Campaign editor
Review Queue	Creative, category, disclosure, animation, links, beneficiary	Reviewer / approver
Live Operations	Pause, fallback, schedule, health, incident banner	Operator
Sponsor Reports	Viewability, clicks, device mix, export, proof screenshots	Analyst / sponsor read-only

C / ADMIN EXPERIENCE

Tournament creation workflow



C / ADMIN EXPERIENCE

Sponsor Studio: panel-by-panel specification

Panel	Controls	Live preview requirement
Overview	Campaign state, completeness, warnings, version, sponsor, tournament	All device thumbnails
Brand kit	Display name, logo, palette, background, contrast treatment	Header + arena
Placements	Enable zones, asset mapping, copy, CTA, disclosure	Zone overlays
Motion	Approved preset, speed, pause, reduced-motion fallback	Play/pause side-by-side
Cause	Mode, beneficiary, message, verification, disclosures	Collapsed + expanded
Schedule	Start/end, timezone, fallback, pause on incident	Timeline
Review	Automated results, reviewer notes, diff, approvals	Version comparison
Reporting	Delivery health, viewability, clicks, export	Metric cards

C / ADMIN EXPERIENCE

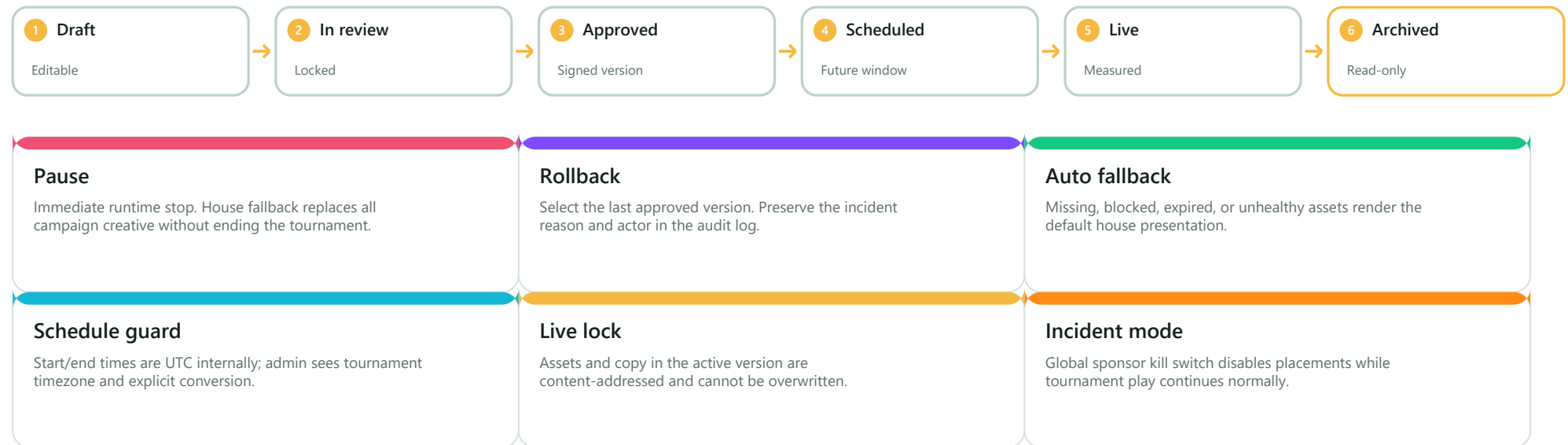
Preview matrix and approval gate

Preview	Must show	Block publish when
Desktop waiting	Background, logo tile, feature panel, disclosure	Core UI occluded or contrast fails
Desktop playing	Turn state, sponsor motion, cause collapsed	CTA overlaps actions or timer
Mobile waiting	Compact logo, background, disclosure	Any horizontal/vertical overflow
Mobile playing	Thumb path, turn controls, collapsed cause	Sponsor unit enters touch exclusion zone
Result	Small signature only	Logo obscures score or play-again
Reduced motion	Static logo + no looping movement	Animation persists
Asset failure	House fallback, no broken image	Fallback missing
Long translation	Expansion and wrapping	Disclosure truncates

Approval gate recommendation: campaign owner requests review; reviewer resolves all warnings; authorized approver publishes. Live edits always create a new draft, never mutate the active version.

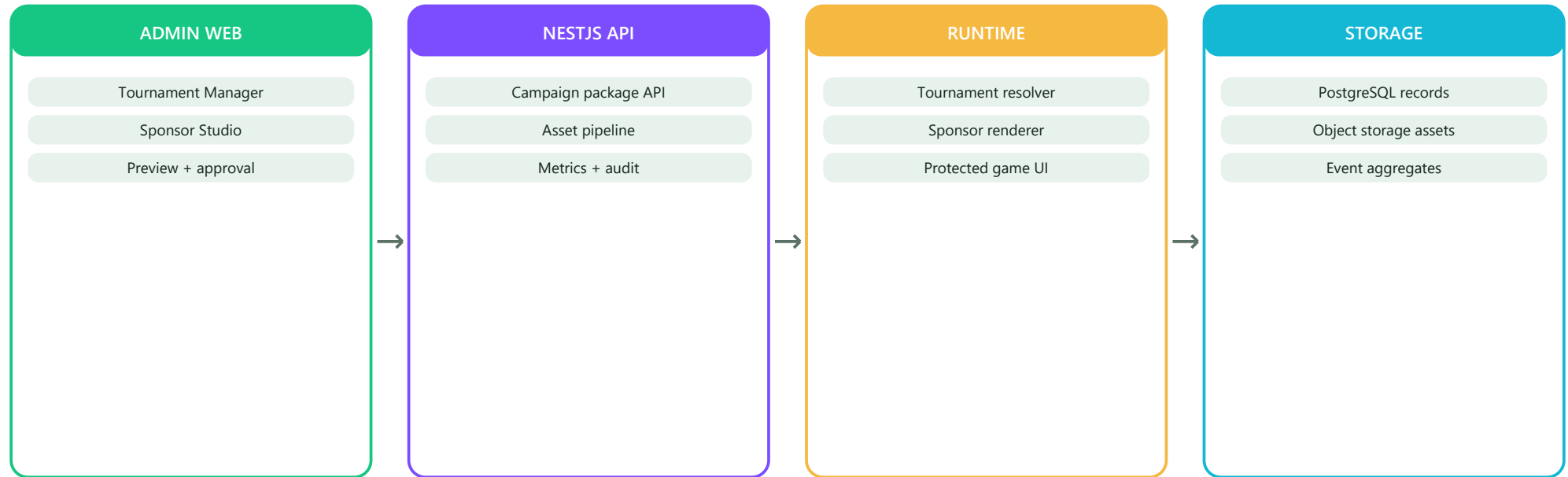
C / ADMIN EXPERIENCE

Campaign lifecycle and rollback



D / TECHNICAL DESIGN

Recommended system architecture

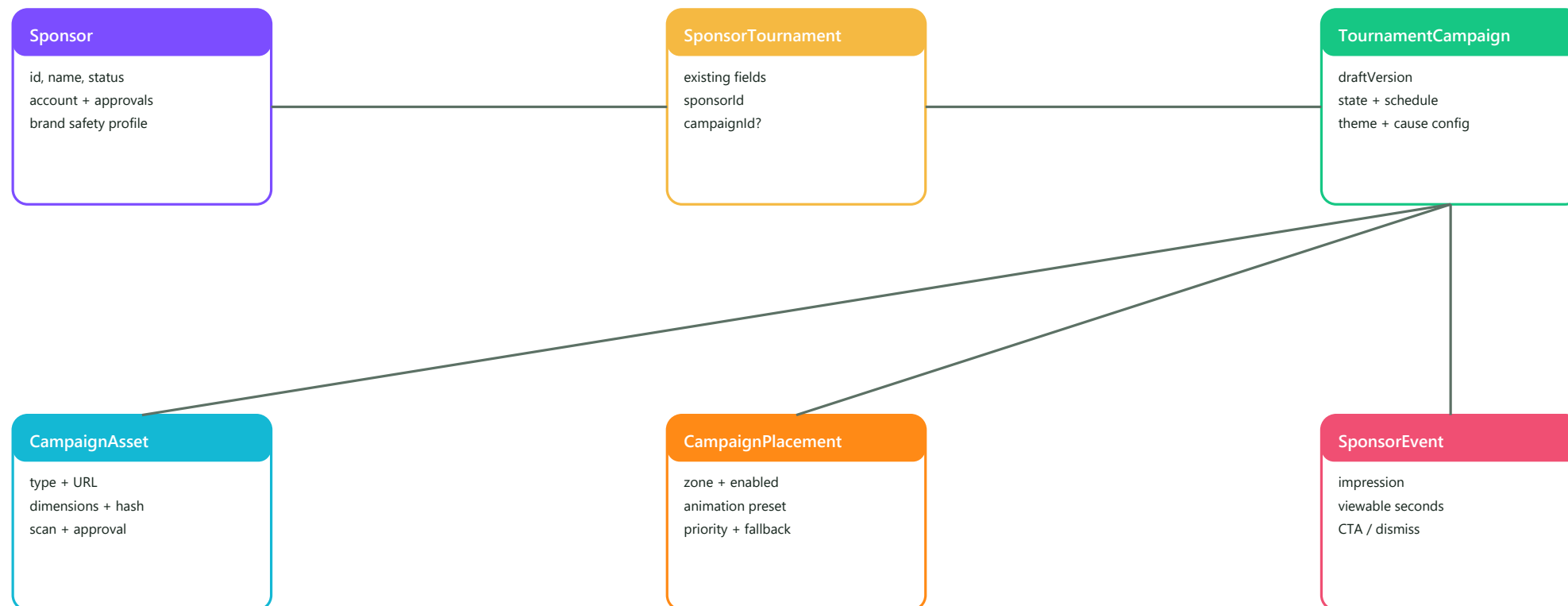


Runtime resolution: roomId tour:{id} -> tournament -> active approved campaign version -> placement manifest -> prevalidated assets. Practice mode and tournaments without an active campaign use DEFAULT_GAME_CONFIG and house assets.

Keep gameplay configuration and campaign presentation as separate schemas. A campaign manifest may reference safe visual tokens but cannot include gameplay fields, avatar IDs, card logic, timers, skills, bot settings, or arbitrary CSS.

D / TECHNICAL DESIGN

Data model extension



Recommended relational additions: TournamentCampaign, CampaignVersion, CampaignAsset, CampaignPlacement, CampaignApproval, SponsorEventAggregate, and CampaignAuditLog. Keep SponsorTournament.sponsorId as the commercial ownership link; add activeCampaignVersionId only after approval.

D / TECHNICAL DESIGN

Campaign manifest: allowlist, not a free-form page builder

Group	Example fields	Validation
identity	sponsorName, disclosureLabel, campaignTitle	length, plain text, approved sponsor
theme	primary, secondary, backgroundAssetId, overlay	color format, contrast, opacity bounds
logoTile	assetId, preset, speedTier, desktop/mobile enabled	asset type, preset enum, size bounds
featurePanel	assetId, headline, body, ctaLabel, ctaUrl	copy limits, HTTPS allowlist
cause	enabled, mode, beneficiary, message, disclosures	verification required for fundraiser
resultSignature	enabled, assetId, label	static only
schedule	startsAt, endsAt, timezoneDisplay	UTC storage, end after start

The UI may feel like a visual builder, but the saved output is a strict, versioned JSON manifest backed by relational records and enums. This gives drag-and-select convenience without arbitrary layout or code execution risk.

D / TECHNICAL DESIGN

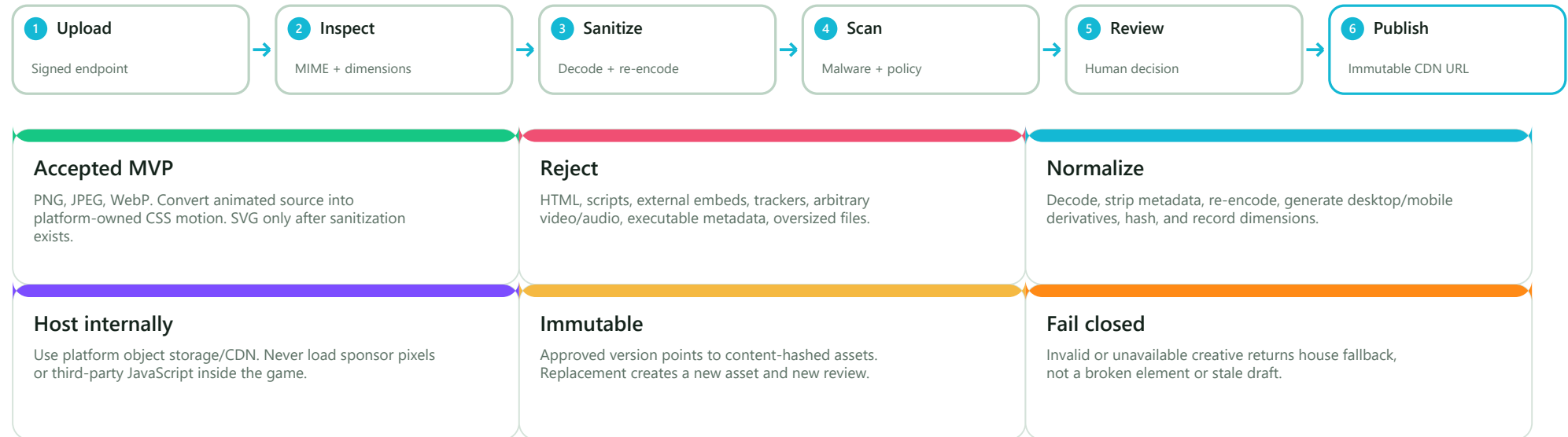
API surface and authorization

Route group	Examples	Authorization
Admin campaigns	POST /admin/tournaments/:id/campaigns; PATCH draft	ADMIN + campaign:write
Assets	POST /admin/campaign-assets; scan/status	ADMIN; signed upload
Review	submit, approve, reject, pause, rollback	Distinct review/publish scopes
Runtime	GET /tournaments/:id/campaign-manifest	Public; active version only; cacheable
Events	POST /sponsor-events/batch	Session token; rate limited; schema strict
Reports	GET /admin/campaigns/:id/report	ADMIN or owning sponsor read-only

Do not expose draft asset URLs, reviewer notes, verification evidence, contract data, raw identifiers, or unpublished campaign versions through public tournament endpoints.

D / TECHNICAL DESIGN

Asset pipeline and creative safety



D / TECHNICAL DESIGN

Measurement that sponsors can trust

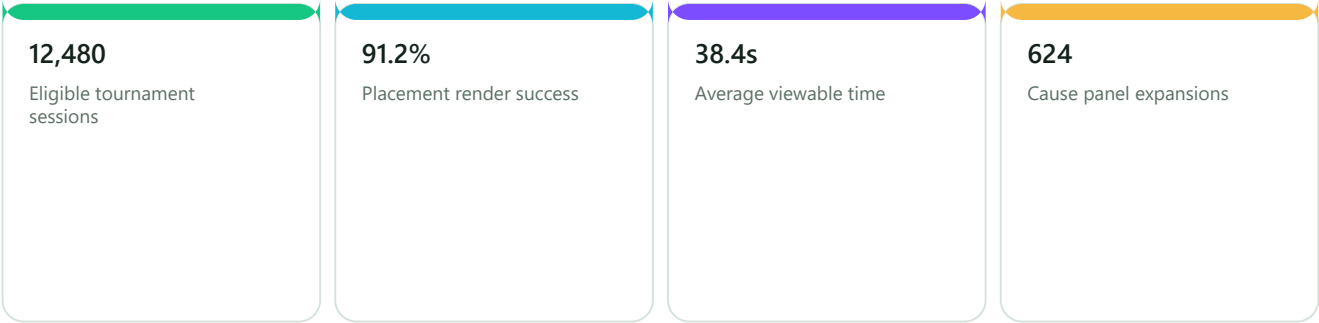
Use the IAB gaming framework as direction, but start with auditable first-party aggregates rather than overstating certification.

Metric	Definition	Do not count
Eligible load	Approved placement requested in a live tournament	Draft, preview, bot/admin test
Rendered impression	Creative decoded and rendered in its intended zone	Fallback or hidden tab
Viewable seconds	Placement visible, tab active, sufficient on-screen area	Background tab, covered modal
Completed loop	One approved animation cycle completed while viewable	Static fallback or interrupted loop
Cause expand	Player deliberately opens collapsed cause panel	Automatic display
CTA click	Deliberate click after disclosure	Programmatic navigation, repeat spam
Unique session reach	Distinct tournament sessions, privacy-safe	Cross-site identity graph

Report delivery health separately from audience outcomes. Label internal methodology clearly; do not claim MRC accreditation unless independently audited and accredited.

D / TECHNICAL DESIGN

Sponsor report: useful proof, not vanity numbers



Report section	Contents
Delivery	Loads, render success, fallback rate, asset errors, campaign uptime
Attention proxy	Viewable seconds distribution and completed loops by placement
Interaction	Cause expands, CTA clicks, click rate with bot/rate filters
Audience context	Tournament, device class, viewport tier, broad region if lawful
Proof	Campaign version hash, schedule, creative thumbnails, disclosure screenshots
Export	CSV aggregates + branded PDF summary; no raw personal player data

E / PROTECTION

Child safety, accessibility, and attention safeguards

Protection	Required behavior
Ad category policy	Block gambling, alcohol, nicotine, weapons, sexual content, political persuasion for minors, deceptive finance, and age-inappropriate products.
Contextual delivery	Campaign selection is tied to the tournament and schedule, not behavioral profiles or retargeting.
Data minimization	No third-party pixels; no sponsor access to player identities; reports use aggregate context.
Motion	Pause/stop/hide for motion over five seconds; prefers-reduced-motion uses static creative.
Flashing	No more than three flashes per second; preferred policy is no flashing at all.
Contrast	Locked game contrast overlay; disclosure and CTA meet WCAG contrast and non-text contrast expectations.
Cognitive load	One moving sponsor object at a time; short copy; no countdown pressure attached to ads.
Input safety	No sponsor interaction during active turns; keyboard and screen-reader labels remain game-first.

E / PROTECTION

Roles, approvals, and operational controls

Role	Can	Cannot
Campaign editor	Create draft, upload, configure, request review	Approve or publish own campaign
Creative reviewer	Review claims, category, disclosure, links, motion	Change tournament rules
Publisher	Approve schedule, publish, pause, rollback	Edit approved content in place
Tournament operator	Run event, monitor health, trigger fallback	Alter sponsor assets
Sponsor viewer	View own approved campaign and reports	Access player data or other sponsors
Super admin	Emergency kill switch and access administration	Bypass audit log

Audit every create, edit, upload, submit, approve, reject, schedule, pause, rollback, asset scan result, CTA domain change, beneficiary verification, and report export with actor, timestamp, old/new version, and reason.

F / DELIVERY

Hypothetical campaign: Nike Future Champions Cup

Planning example only. Nike has not sponsored, approved, or endorsed this project. Use text placeholders until a real agreement and brand kit exist.

Campaign item	Hypothetical configuration
Sponsor	Nike - hypothetical planning record
Package	Tournament takeover
Theme	Deep charcoal arena, white typography, restrained volt accent, house contrast mask
Animated tile	Text placeholder NIKE; Float preset; 6-second loop; static reduced-motion fallback
Feature panel	'Every move builds the future' plus campaign artwork placeholder
Cause	Awareness mode: fund community sports kits; beneficiary verification required before activation
Mobile	Background + compact logo tile + collapsed cause card; no feature panel
Disclosure	'Sponsored by Nike - hypothetical demo' on every sponsor surface
Schedule	48-hour test environment, then one tournament window; automatic house fallback

This scenario proves the modular workflow without using copied logos, proprietary artwork, campaign claims, or a real charity relationship. Replace every placeholder only after contract, asset, claim, and beneficiary approval.

F / DELIVERY

Implementation roadmap

Phase	Scope	Exit gate
0 - Decisions	Approve zones, policy, roles, metrics, fundraising boundary	Signed product decisions
1 - Data + API	Campaign/version/asset schema, strict manifest, permissions, audit	Backend tests + migration rollback
2 - Admin Studio	Builder panels, upload pipeline, previews, validation	Draft saved without global config changes
3 - Runtime	Resolver, desktop/mobile placements, fallbacks, reduced motion	Practice and core game unchanged
4 - Review + Ops	Approval lifecycle, schedule, pause, rollback, health	Incident drill passes
5 - Measurement	Aggregate events, sponsor report, exports, proof	Metrics reconciliation passes
6 - Pilot	One internal hypothetical campaign, then one contracted sponsor	Postmortem + owner approval

Recommended implementation order is backend contract first, admin second, runtime third. Do not start with a visual-only mock wired to global GameConfig; that would recreate the coupling this plan is designed to remove.

F / DELIVERY

Definition of done: core acceptance criteria

Area	Acceptance criteria
Isolation	Publishing campaign A changes only its assigned tournament; practice and tournament B remain byte-for-byte equivalent in protected configuration.
Game integrity	Board, avatars, timer, controls, skills, rules, hit targets, and outcome logic are unchanged under every campaign.
Fallback	Disable, expiry, network failure, invalid asset, and kill switch restore house presentation without reload or game interruption.
Responsive	Desktop, tablet, mobile, short-height, zoom, and safe-area layouts have no sponsor overlap or scrolling regression.
Accessibility	Reduced motion static fallback, pause/hide motion, contrast, focus order, labels, and flash checks pass.
Security	No executable creative, external trackers, draft leakage, cross-sponsor access, unsafe URL, or MIME spoofing.
Approval	Live version cannot be edited; requester cannot self-approve; all state transitions are audited.
Measurement	Preview/admin/bot sessions excluded; events deduplicated; aggregates reconcile with sampled raw event windows.
Cause	Fundraising cannot publish without beneficiary and disclosure fields; CTA is suppressed during active turns.

F / DELIVERY

Test strategy

Schema + permissions

Unit tests for strict manifests, transitions, roles, URL and asset validation.

Migration safety

Forward/back migration in a production-shaped database; existing tournaments still resolve.

Visual regression

Protected zones compared across house and sponsor campaigns at supported viewports.

Runtime failure

Asset 404, timeout, corrupt image, expired campaign, cache stale, and API outage.

Accessibility

Keyboard, screen reader, contrast, reduced motion, pause/hide, flashing, zoom, reflow.

Analytics

Deduplication, hidden tab, modal coverage, idle session, bot traffic, preview exclusion.

Operations drill

Pause campaign and global kill switch while a live match continues.

Security

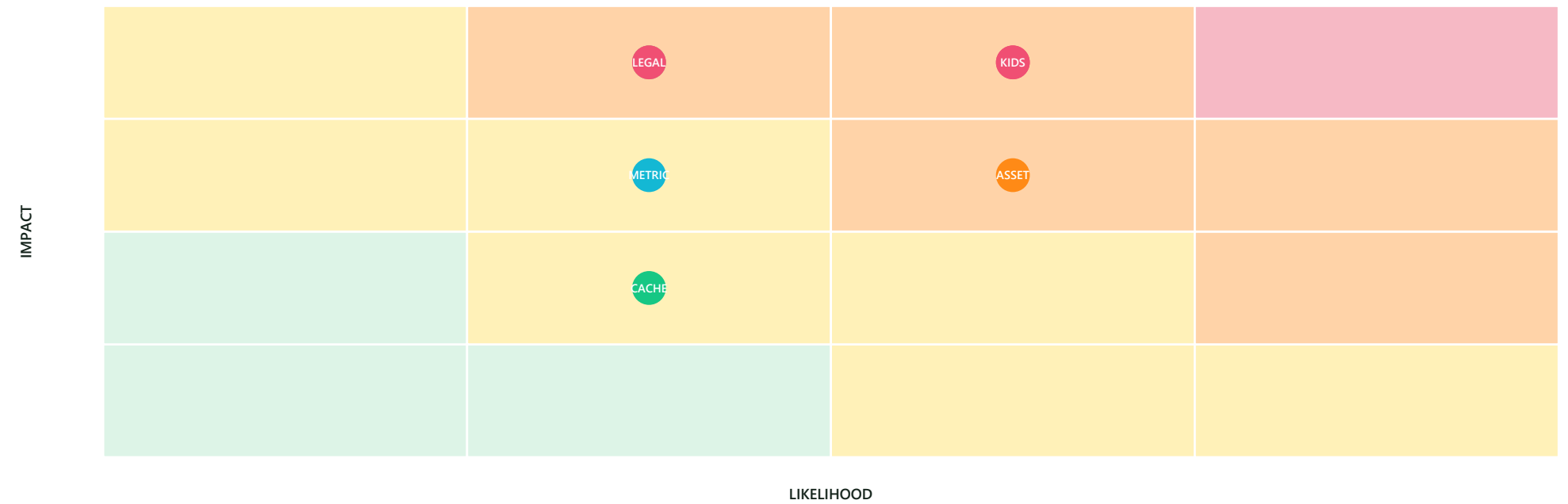
MIME spoof, SVG script, malicious metadata, cross-tenant reads, draft URL guessing, XSS copy.

Load + cache

Tournament start spike, manifest CDN cache, event batching, asset warmup, fallback latency.

F / DELIVERY

Risk register



Code	Risk	Primary mitigation
UI	Sponsor obscures gameplay	Fixed zones + visual regression + runtime bounds
KIDS	Age-inappropriate or manipulative ad	Category policy + contextual only + reviewer gate
DATA	Sponsor receives player data	Aggregate reports + authorization + no pixels
OPS	Bad campaign goes live	Two-person approval + pause + house fallback
LEGAL	Misleading ad/fundraising claim	Disclosure fields + verification + legal review

F / DELIVERY

Deliberately out of scope for MVP

Ad exchange No programmatic bidding, real-time auctions, or third-party ad network tags.	Behavioral targeting No retargeting, cross-site identity, interest profiles, or sponsor audience lists.	Native donations No collection, custody, receipts, tax claims, fee splitting, or beneficiary payout.
Sponsor code No sponsor JavaScript, HTML, CSS, webviews, pixels, or remote embeds.	Gameplay sponsorship No sponsored cards, skills, outcomes, avatars, timers, boosts, or pay-to-win effects.	Influencers Influencer teams and endorsements remain a separate later workflow as requested.

These exclusions are strategic. They let the platform prove safe sponsor value, operational reliability, and trustworthy reporting before adding legal, privacy, payments, or endorsement complexity.

OWNER DECISION GATE

Decisions required before implementation

Decision	Recommended default	Owner approval
Sponsor Studio scope	Tournament-only campaign layer	☐
Protected zones	Board, avatars, controls, skills, timer, HUD, nav	☐
MVP placements	Background, logo tile, desktop panel, cause, lobby, result	☐
Mobile policy	No feature panel; compact logo + collapsed cause	☐
Animation	Six platform presets; no arbitrary CSS	☐
Fundraising	External verified CTA only; no native donations	☐
Targeting	Contextual tournament/schedule only	☐
Approval	Editor + reviewer/publisher separation	☐
Pilot	Hypothetical internal test, then one contracted sponsor	☐

Approval of this document authorizes detailed implementation planning only if the owner explicitly says to proceed. It does not authorize sponsor outreach, trademark use, public deployment, payment handling, or fundraising claims.

RESEARCH NOTES

Sources and standards consulted

Primary sources used to shape disclosure, measurement, accessibility, child-safety, and fundraising recommendations.

IAB Gaming Measurement Framework (2025)	https://www.iab.com/guidelines/gaming-measurement-framework/	Standard gaming ad formats and baseline/additional metrics.
IAB / MRC Intrinsic In-Game Measurement Guidelines	https://www.iab.com/blog/intrinsic-in-game-measurement-guidelines/	In-game delivery, impression, viewability, inactivity, and fraud direction.
FTC Native Advertising Guide	https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/native-advertising-guide-businesses	Clear, prominent, proximate, understandable ad disclosures.
FTC COPPA FAQ	https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/complying-coppa-frequently-asked-questions	Child-directed service factors; contextual vs behavioral advertising concerns.
ICO Age Appropriate Design Code	https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/uk-gdpr-guidance-and-resources/childrens-information/childrens-code-guidance-and-resources/age-appropriate-design-a-code-of-practice-for-online-services/	Best interests of children, profiling, and built-in protection.
W3C WCAG 2.2 - Pause, Stop, Hide	https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/pause-stop-hide.html	Control for auto-moving content over five seconds.
W3C WCAG 2.2 - Three Flashes	https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/three-flashes-or-below-threshold	Flash thresholds and seizure protection.
FTC Online Charitable Giving Portals	https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/online-charitable-giving-portals	Clear donor disclosures about recipient, fees, timing, and data sharing.

This document is a product and technical plan, not legal advice. Jurisdiction, audience age, sponsor category, prize structure, fundraising arrangement, and data practices require qualified legal review before launch.